

TV SHOW

Arcane

★★★★★ | Being a massive League of Legends fan and long time player myself, I will probably come across as biased with this review of Arcane, but trust me when I say that this is one of the best animated shows of all time. Most gamers aren't really too concerned about the lore in games, unless they're diehard RPG nuts, like I am. Then again, most competitively played games today don't really bother with the lore. League of Legends hits that sweet spot where you could enjoy the game if you didn't care about the lore, but if you did there was a mountain of lore and backstory to sift through. For years now people have been asking Riot to come out with a full blown series. There was certainly no shortage of interesting characters or story angles; they could make a series for just about any character in the game. The



only thing they had to worry about was disappointing the fans, so it's about time we finally got a series.

Anyway, I've gone on too long without actually talking about the show. Arcane is a story that revolves around Piltover and Zuan, two regions in the world of Runeterra that are right beside each other. Or rather, Piltover is on top of

Zuan. Piltover is the "City of Progress" while Zuan represents the ugly underbelly. Zuan wants to become a sovereign nation, free of Piltover, which kind of makes sense because Piltover wants nothing to do with Zuan and uses it as a dumping ground. The series features a lot of favourites from the game who belong to these regions, with the story largely revolving around the sisters, Jinx and Vi. There's major appearances from characters like Ekko, Caitlyn, Jayce, Heimerdinger, Singed and possibly more. But don't worry! Even if you're unfamiliar with the game, it's characters and the world of Runeterra, Riot has ensured that the show can be watched by just about anyone. The animation and voice acting is fantastic. There's also an amazing soundtrack to go with the show (the opening credits song is sung by Imagine Dragons), packed with appearances from big shot music artists. The season ends on a massive cliffhanger and we've got to wait till 2023 for season 2. That's literally the only downside we have for Arcane.

— Manish Rajesh

MOVIE

Dune (2021)

★★★★☆ | Denis Villeneuve seems to have done his research since his adaptation of Dune, so far, has overcome the shortfalls of the previous two adaptations. Let's begin with the casting. Timothée Chalamet is a better Paul Atreides since the books have the character as a 15-year old boy whereas the 1984 movie had a grown man playing the role. More appropriately, Timothée Chalamet is a better Paul Atreides because he is a better actor. Oscar Issac as Duke Atreides, Rebecca Ferguson as Lady Jessica, Stellan Skarsgård as Baron Vladimir Harkonnen are spot on castings and they play their characters very well. Charlotte Rampling as Gaius Helen Mohiam, a Bene Gesserit Reverend Mother, has the same vibe as Olenna Tyrell from Game of Thrones. We could go on but some of the characters have yet to get enough



screen time to have their roles play out properly, so we'll hold judgement on that for now. Then there's the world, costume and set design. Dune is set in an era where computers have been outlawed after an automaton rebellion wiped out a huge chunk of the human race. So the tech used by each faction is very much advanced but it falls short of being "intelligent". The roles of computers are held by Mentats who're trained to be walking and talking human computers. Everything from the heavy machinery used for

harvesting Melange (or "The Spice"), the communication equipment, the ornithopters, etc. all follow this principle and look the part. Costume design, on the other hand, felt a little lacking. They've done a heck of a lot better job than the 1984 movie or the 2001 mini-series but the Atreides clan's uniforms and those worn by the Sardaukar seem comical. Sardaukar, which are one of the most ferocious armies in the book, seem like clowns trying to fight in unwieldy space-suits. Folks who aren't familiar with the series might call it a slow-burn because there are several parts in the movie where the pace does slow down. However, this is the first of the trilogy and is meant to introduce the series and set the pace for what's to become of young Paul Atreides. With that in mind, the movie seems to be running at the right pace. In summary, Denis Villeneuve's Dune is a much better adaptation and one that's bound to evoke your interest in the Dune universe for just the right amount of time till the next movie comes out.

— Mithun Mohandas